

Comprehensive Legal, Evidentiary, and Remedial Framework: Addressing Disability Discrimination, Defamation, and Administrative Malpractice at the University of Galway

1. Executive Strategic Review and Case Orientation

This exhaustive research report investigates a highly complex, multi-layered dispute involving severe disability discrimination, administrative malpractice, and implicit defamation within the University of Galway's School of Education. The factual matrix centers on an alumnus and highly qualified teaching professional who holds a First Class Honours Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics and Education (2021) and a Higher Diploma in Software Design (2023). Despite an objective, documented history of academic excellence, innovative pedagogical research, and glowing placement reports, the subject is currently facing a coordinated institutional barrier to professional entry.

Specifically, Professor Anthony Hall—who previously granted the subject an academic extension in 2013 and has recently attained prominent appointments on the Teaching Council and the State Examinations Commission—is refusing to provide a standard "Fit and Proper Person" character reference required for the subject's teacher registration. Furthermore, compelling evidence indicates systemic interference within the faculty, whereby previously glowing references from respected academics such as Cornelia Connolly and Kathy O'Sullivan have been revoked or suppressed under institutional pressure. This obstruction is compounded by a highly contradictory and discriminatory rejection from the Máistir Gairmiúil san Oideachas (MGO) postgraduate programme.

This refusal is not an isolated exercise of academic discretion; rather, it is deeply entwined with the subject's documented clinical profile. The subject manages Complex Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (CPTSD) and an Anxiety Disorder intricately linked to severe familial abuse, the prolonged palliative care of a grandfather, and the subsequent waning health of a grandmother for whom the subject acted as a primary carer. By weaponizing an inappropriate 2023 psychiatric request—which was improperly based upon a misdiagnosis originating from a professor of psychiatry associated with the subject's abusive older brother—and relying on familial rumors rather than objective academic records, the School of Education is engaging in profound discriminatory profiling.

This sustained conduct has exacerbated the subject's trauma, invoking the "eggshell skull" doctrine under Irish tort law, which holds the institution liable for the full extent of the resulting psychiatric injury. The gaslighting and reputational damage inflicted upon the subject, particularly among past peers at Coláiste na Coiribe and Galway Community College, demands immediate legal remediation. This report systematically deconstructs the legal liabilities surrounding the refusal of the Teaching Council reference, the discriminatory rejection from the MGO, and the subsequent defamatory harm. Finally, it provides a robust, actionable remedial

framework, including an exhaustively drafted Workplace Relations Commission (WRC) ES.1 Notification Form and a statutory "Offer of Amends" compromise letter drafted pursuant to Section 22 of the Defamation Act 2009.

2. The Medical and Psychiatric Matrix: Invoking the Eggshell Skull Doctrine

To comprehend the legal severity of the School of Education's actions, a forensic understanding of the subject's documented medical and psychiatric profile is required. The administrative obstruction is not occurring in a vacuum; it is interacting directly with a highly vulnerable neurological state, creating profound liabilities for the University of Galway under Irish personal injury law.

2.1 Formal Psychiatric Diagnoses and Etiology

Medical documentation from the University's own Student Health Unit and external specialists confirms severe, chronic psychiatric disabilities. In 2017, Dr. James McLoughlin, a Consultant Psychiatrist at Galway University Hospital, formally diagnosed the subject with an Anxiety Disorder with an onset dating to 2015. The clinical report explicitly notes a multifactorial etiology involving chronic stressors and a positive familial history. Concurrently, a separate medical assessment by Dr. McLoughlin details a primary diagnosis of Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (PTSD), coded under the international classification as ICD-10 F43.12. The clinical findings emphatically note that the patient presented with "significant distress" due to historical abuse issues and exhibited a clear "picture of PTSD".

The psychological profile is inextricably linked to severe familial abuse and profound personal tragedy. The subject endured immense emotional and physical strain while performing the palliative care of their grandfather, a trauma that necessitated repeating the third year of their degree program for six consecutive years. Following the loss of the grandfather, the subject immediately transitioned into a primary carer role for their grandmother amid her waning health. The University of Galway was formally aware of these circumstances; indeed, Professor Anthony Hall personally granted the subject an academic extension in 2013 for an education philosophy module directly due to these caregiving responsibilities. The University's Student Counselling Service, via Head of Service James McCormack, further confirmed that the subject attended recurring counseling from 2016 to 2023 to manage anxiety, which manifested physically during stressful situations such as assignment deadlines and job interviews, frequently necessitating specific accommodations from the Disability Service.

2.2 The Inappropriate 2023 Psychiatric Request and Familial Misdiagnosis

The core of the discriminatory profiling lies in the University's inappropriate handling of the subject's medical data in 2023. Despite the existence of a highly accurate, university-sanctioned diagnosis of CPTSD and Anxiety Disorder from Dr. James McLoughlin in 2017, the School of Education inappropriately demanded a new psychiatric reference. This demand was heavily prejudiced by external familial rumors and specifically relied upon a severe misdiagnosis generated by a professor of psychiatry who was directly associated with the subject's abusive

older brother.

The reliance on a compromised medical opinion originating from the very family matrix responsible for the subject's childhood abuse constitutes a gross violation of medical objectivity and administrative fairness. By allowing unverified familial rumors and a tainted psychiatric assessment to override the objective 2017 diagnosis and the subject's stellar academic record, Professor Hall and the School of Education engaged in direct disability discrimination. They essentially penalized the subject for the behavioral manifestations of their trauma, labeling them "unfit" based on the whisper network of their abusers rather than their pedagogical capabilities.

2.3 The Eggshell Skull Doctrine in Irish Tort Law

The actions of Professor Hall and the School of Education—refusing standard references, suppressing past positive endorsements, and weaponizing tainted psychiatric data—constitute severe administrative harassment. From a legal standpoint, the psychiatric injury caused by this systemic gaslighting is governed by the "eggshell skull" doctrine (often referred to interchangeably as the "thin skull" rule).

Under Irish personal injury and tort law, the "eggshell skull" doctrine mandates a fundamental principle of causation: a defendant must "take their victim as they find them". If a defendant's negligent, discriminatory, or malicious actions aggravate a pre-existing medical or psychiatric condition, the defendant is held legally liable for the full extent of the resulting harm, regardless of whether a person of so-called "ordinary fortitude" would have suffered to the same catastrophic degree. The jurisprudence dictates that foreseeability relates to the nature of the loss, not its ultimate extent; thus, if it is reasonably foreseeable that discriminatory behavior will cause injury to feelings, the wrongdoer is liable for the complete psychological breakdown that follows.

Because the University of Galway was formally aware of the subject's CPTSD and Anxiety Disorder through the Access Centre, Student Counselling, and Professor Hall's own previous academic accommodations, the subject's psychological vulnerability was a documented institutional fact. By systematically dismantling the subject's professional career through administrative obstruction, the institution triggered a severe, predictable exacerbation of the CPTSD. The autonomic nervous system's response to this profound institutional betrayal—especially when intrinsically linked to the original familial trauma through the reliance on the older brother's network—has caused a catastrophic psychiatric injury for which the University of Galway is strictly and vicariously liable.

3. Objective Evidentiary Matrix of Academic and Pedagogical Excellence

To establish the legal principle of estoppel—which strictly prevents an institution or individual from subsequently contradicting their own prior formal certifications of fitness—it is necessary to forensically examine the subject's objective academic and professional record. The refusal to provide a Teaching Council character reference must be weighed against the University's own grading rubrics, the subject's innovative research outputs, and the glowing feedback of external placement schools.

3.1 Academic Record and First Class Honours Validation

The empirical evidence of the subject's academic prowess is incontrovertibly demonstrated by the official University of Galway transcript. Conferring a First Class Honours Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics and Education in 2021, the institution formally certified the subject's mastery of both rigorous mathematical theorems and advanced pedagogical methodologies. The overall degree mark of 78.84% stands as a testament to unparalleled dedication, particularly when contextualized against the severe personal and clinical adversities endured during the course of study. The transcript further notes the conferral of the title "University Scholar", an institutional accolade reserved exclusively for students demonstrating exceptional academic merit on the results of their university examinations.

The subject demonstrated profound, consistent competence across diverse modules, bridging the gap between theoretical mathematics, applied statistics, and educational psychology.

Module Code	Module Title	Result (%)	Status
ST311	Applied Statistics I	98%	Pass
MA378	Numerical Analysis II	97%	Pass
ST312	Applied Statistics II	94%	Pass
MP307	Modelling II	90%	Pass
CS4423	Networks	89%	Pass
ED411	Final-Year Symposium	80%	Pass
ED413	Block Teaching Practice	70%	Pass
ED109	Principles of Second-Level Mathematics	70%	Pass

The award of 70% in the Final Year Block Teaching Practice (ED413) is of paramount legal significance. This grade represents a definitive, heavily moderated institutional certification of the subject's practical classroom competence, student management capabilities, and overall professional fitness to teach. Any subsequent claim of "unfitness" by Professor Hall directly contradicts the University's own academic assessment and violates the foundational principles of administrative consistency.

3.2 Advanced Pedagogical Innovation: The Plickers Action Research Project

The subject's final year action research project, titled *"How can I use a classroom response system to facilitate constructivist teaching and learning in my post-primary mathematics classroom?"*, stands as empirical proof of advanced pedagogical capability and a deep commitment to student-centric learning.

The research investigated the integration of the "Plickers" classroom response system into mathematics instruction to actively promote a constructivist learning environment. Recognizing the limitations of traditional "chalk-and-talk" transmission methods, the subject designed an intervention to enhance formative assessment and personalized feedback. The subject demonstrated immense technical ingenuity by utilizing "TeXify-Plickers" to render complex mathematical notation (LaTeX) within the application, and deploying repeating Graphic Interchange Formats (GIFs) to aid students in the spatial visualization of geometry and volume. The findings of this exhaustive project were highly significant and professionally executed:

- **Enhanced Student Engagement:** The intervention led to post-primary mathematics students becoming significantly more comfortable sharing opinions in class, breaking

down the traditional barriers of mathematics anxiety.

- **Statistical Correlation and Analysis:** The subject utilized RStudio to conduct paired Wilcoxon signed-rank tests and paired t-tests on Likert scale survey data, discovering a moderate positive correlation (Spearman coefficient 0.53) between a student's engagement in classroom discussion and their subsequent mathematics test scores.
- **Reflective Practice:** The project highlighted the subject's deep capacity for critical reflection. By maintaining a reflective journal and utilizing Brookfield's four lenses of reflection, the subject demonstrated an ability to adapt teaching strategies dynamically based on student feedback, embodying the very definition of a reflective practitioner.

3.3 Subject Matter Versatility: Computer Science and History of Education

Beyond the core mathematics curriculum, the subject has consistently demonstrated exceptional intellectual versatility. A presentation delivered for the NUI Galway Taster Day on the subject of "Mathematics, Computer Science, and Education" successfully mapped the complex intersection of fundamental mathematical logic with practical computing. The presentation guided students through the "Map of Mathematics," connecting concepts such as Turing Machines, P vs NP complexity, and Cryptography to practical coding environments like Python, Scratch, and the Raspberry Pi ecosystem. This presentation, which received a standing ovation, underscores a high-level capability for public speaking, student engagement, and complex knowledge translation.

Furthermore, the subject's academic assignment on the "History and Structure of Irish Education" (Module ED116) exhibits advanced analytical skills regarding educational sociology and policy. The paper forensically examined the evolution of patronage in Irish education, rigorously tracking the transition from the discriminatory Penal Laws of 1695, through the aspirational Stanley Letter of 1831, up to the modern challenges addressed by the 2011 Forum on Patronage and Pluralism. This demonstrates a deeply nuanced understanding of the sociological, historical, and structural frameworks of the Irish educational system—a core competency demanded of any registered teacher.

3.4 External Validation: Galway Community College Reference

The ultimate test of a teacher's character, resilience, and fitness to practice is their performance in a live, high-pressure school environment. A formal reference from Evelyn Jackson, the Professional Master of Education (PME) Coordinator at Galway Community College (GCC), dated April 23, 2021, provides incontrovertible, independent proof of the subject's professional character.

Evaluation Metric	Feedback from Galway Community College (GCC)
Professionalism & Reliability	The subject was "always punctual and thoroughly prepared for his classes," maintaining "excellent" attendance throughout the placement duration.
Initiative & Student Support	Described as "eager to take on extra duties," the subject voluntarily provided after-school study supervision, offering specific, targeted

Evaluation Metric	Feedback from Galway Community College (GCC)
	help to students preparing for Leaving Cert Maths.
Subject Expertise & Rapport	The coordinator explicitly noted that the subject has a "good rapport with his students" and is "very knowledgeable in his subject."
Character Disposition	The subject is noted for possessing a "very gentle nature and a positive attitude." The coordinator concluded with "no doubt he will continue to influence students positively in the future."

This objective, independent validation from a functioning, respected educational institution renders the School of Education's current refusal to provide a character reference entirely arbitrary, legally suspect, and indicative of profound institutional bias.

4. The Administrative Impasse and Teaching Council Regulations

The refusal to provide the Teaching Council reference represents an unprecedented intersection of administrative malpractice, breach of statutory duty, and institutional conflict of interest.

4.1 The Teaching Council "Five-Year Rule" and the Imminent Cliff Edge

Registration with the Teaching Council of Ireland is a strict statutory requirement for employment as a teacher in state-funded schools. To gain admission to the register, an applicant must prove they are a "fit and proper person". Because the Teaching Council does not continuously monitor university students, this assessment is entirely delegated to Higher Education Institutions (HEIs). This is facilitated by a Character Reference Form (Form D), which relies on the "negative assurance" of trusted professionals.

The regulatory guidelines stipulate rigid validity criteria for this form. It must be signed by an individual in a position of academic responsibility (such as a Lecturer or Head of School Placement) who has known the applicant in a professional capacity for at least one academic year *within the last five years*.

The subject graduated from the Bachelor of Arts in Mathematics and Education in August 2021. The final relevant academic year overlaps with the 2020/2021 session. Calculated forward from that point, the five-year statutory window for a University of Galway lecturer to validly sign this character reference expires entirely by the summer of 2026.

4.2 Professor Hall's Conflict of Interest and the Suppression of References

Professor Anthony Hall, who taught the History and Philosophy of Education module and previously granted the subject a vital academic extension in 2013 due to the palliative care of the subject's grandfather, is uniquely positioned to sign this form. Hall is a Full Professor of

Education and holds highly prominent, influential appointments with both the State Examinations Commission and the Teaching Council itself.

Professor Hall's deliberate refusal to sign this administrative document is not a passive bureaucratic delay; it is an active, constructive barrier specifically designed to run out the statutory clock. By utilizing his power to delay the process beyond the five-year window, he is attempting to render a First Class Honours degree professionally obsolete, permanently locking the subject out of the teaching profession.

This discriminatory intent is further evidenced by the systemic suppression of alternative avenues for obtaining the reference. Highly respected academics within the university, specifically Cornelia Connolly and Kathy O'Sullivan, who previously provided glowing, unreserved appraisals of the subject's capabilities, have inexplicably revoked those references or had immense institutional pressure applied to suppress them. When a faculty systematically silences its own staff to prevent a disabled First Class Honours graduate from registering with their professional body, the institution crosses the line from academic discretion into unlawful, coordinated victimization.

5. The Circular Logic and Discriminatory Rejection of the MGO Masters

The systemic bias operating within the School of Education culminated in the subject's highly contradictory rejection from the Máistir Gairmiúil san Oideachas (MGO) programme. The MGO is a two-year, full-time postgraduate programme specifically designed to train post-primary teachers to work in Irish-medium schools, such as those in the Gaeltacht and Gaelcholáistí. The subject possesses a profound dedication to the Irish language and education, holding a Level 8 First Class Honours (1.1) in an aligned teaching subject (Mathematics and Education), alongside a First Class Honours HDip in Software Design. The minimum entry requirement for the MGO programme is merely a Second Class Honours Level 8 primary degree.

Despite significantly exceeding the academic baseline, the subject has wasted two years attempting to access this programme, facing arbitrary and shifting goalposts designed to ensure rejection.

5.1 The Phantom Computer Science Stream

In the first instance, the subject applied for the MGO intending to utilize their First Class Honours HDip in Software Design to specialize in teaching Computer Science. Despite the University actively advertising the Computer Science stream for the MGO to attract applicants, the subject was subsequently rejected and informed that the stream was not actually being run due to a "lack of demand". This constitutes a profound misrepresentation of university services, wasting a year of the applicant's life and finances based on phantom curriculum advertising.

5.2 The Catch-22 of the Mathematics Application

In the second instance, the subject pivoted and applied for the Mathematics stream of the MGO, relying on their 2021 First Class Honours degree in English-speaking Mathematics and Education. In a display of breathtaking administrative hypocrisy, the School of Education rejected this application. The stated rationale was that because the subject had obtained their degree in 2021 and possessed "no full-time teaching experience since then," they were

precluded from entering the Irish-speaking Masters.

This reasoning represents a malicious, circular catch-22. The sole reason the subject lacks full-time teaching experience since 2021 is that they cannot legally teach in state schools without Teaching Council registration. They cannot obtain Teaching Council registration because Professor Hall and the School of Education are unlawfully refusing to sign the standard "Fit and Proper Person" reference. The University is therefore weaponizing the very professional deficit they themselves unlawfully created to justify rejecting the subject from further postgraduate study. This logical fallacy exposes the rejection not as an academic decision, but as a coordinated effort to blacklist a disabled student.

6. Defamation, Gaslighting, and Severe Reputational Harm

The refusal of a "Fit and Proper Person" reference, when starkly contrasted against an unblemished academic transcript and universally positive placement records, constitutes an implicit but profound defamatory statement.

6.1 The Mechanics of Implicit Defamation in Academia

Under the Defamation Act 2009, a defamatory statement is defined as one that tends to injure a person's reputation in the eyes of reasonable members of society. In the highly regulated ecosystem of teacher education, the Teaching Council relies entirely on the "negative assurance" of university staff. The character reference form essentially asks the academic to certify that they know of no reason—such as criminal behavior, gross misconduct, or risk to children—why the candidate should not be permitted to teach.

By refusing to sign this document, Professor Hall and the School of Education are implicitly asserting a *positive claim*: they are formally communicating to the regulatory body and the faculty that they possess secret, disqualifying knowledge regarding the subject's character. Because absolutely no such objective academic, disciplinary, or criminal record exists, this assertion is necessarily false. It relies entirely on the malicious misinterpretation of the subject's CPTSD symptoms, the inappropriate 2023 psychiatric misdiagnosis, and the whisper network of familial abusers.

6.2 The Destruction of Peer Relationships

This institutional gaslighting has caused severe, irreparable damage to the subject's professional and personal reputation. The teaching community in Galway is highly interconnected. The subject spent years building professional relationships, demonstrating their gentle nature, and earning the respect of peers and mentors at prestigious institutions such as Coláiste na Coiribe and Galway Community College.

By framing a highly competent, disabled graduate as an institutional risk who is "unfit" to hold a basic reference, the University has poisoned these relationships. The subject's past colleagues are left with the false impression that the subject committed some grave, unspoken offense to warrant the revocation of their First Class Honours degree's utility. This isolation exacerbates the subject's trauma, stripping them of their professional identity and community support network, further triggering the catastrophic psychiatric injuries detailed under the eggshell skull

doctrine.

7. Remedial Framework: WRC ES.1 Notification Form

The subject's core statutory protections against this institutional discrimination lie within the Equal Status Acts 2000-2018. The University of Galway, operating as an educational establishment and service provider, is strictly prohibited from discriminating against a person on the disability ground. Furthermore, Section 4 of the Acts mandates the provision of "reasonable accommodation" unless it causes more than a "nominal cost". The financial cost to Professor Hall to sign a standard reference form is absolutely zero; thus, the refusal is purely an act of prejudicial gatekeeping.

To pursue an Equal Status claim, the complainant must file a Form ES.1 Notification to the respondent within two months of the discriminatory incident. The Director General of the WRC can extend this to four months if "reasonable cause" is demonstrated. The psychiatric paralysis induced by the CPTSD flashbacks—triggered directly by the university's gaslighting—easily satisfies the "reasonable cause" threshold. Furthermore, the systematic revoking of references, the MGO rejections, and Hall's ongoing refusal constitute a legally recognized "continuing act" of discrimination.

The following text is exhaustively drafted for direct insertion into the official WRC Form ES.1 to establish jurisdiction and formally demand accountability from the School of Education.

Section 1: Nature of the Claim ☒ Discriminating against me. ☒ Harassing me, or allowing me to be harassed. ☒ Failing to provide "reasonable accommodation" (applicable for a person with a disability).

Section 2: Grounds for the Complaint ☒ Disability.

Section 3: Details of my complaint I am a severely disabled alumnus of the University of Galway, holding a First Class Honours BA in Mathematics and Education (2021) and a First Class Honours Higher Diploma in Software Design (2023). I am a recognized 'University Scholar' with an objective, documented history of exceptional teaching practice, including a 70% Final Year Block Placement grade, a highly successful Action Research Project utilizing the Plickers educational technology system, and glowing professional references from Galway Community College.

I suffer from Complex Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (CPTSD, ICD-10 F43.12) and a chronic Anxiety Disorder. These conditions were triggered by severe familial abuse, the trauma of providing palliative care for my late grandfather, and acting as a carer for my grandmother amid her waning health. These disabilities were formally diagnosed by Dr. James McLoughlin in 2017 and actively managed by the University Access Centre and Student Counselling Service throughout my studies.

The School of Education is currently engaged in a coordinated, systemic campaign of disability discrimination and harassment designed to permanently destroy my professional career.

Registration with the Teaching Council requires a standard 'Fit and Proper Person' reference from a lecturer who has known me within the last five years. As my BA concluded in 2021, my statutory window to obtain this reference expires in 2026. Professor Anthony Hall—who personally granted me an academic extension in 2013 due to my grandfather's palliative care, and who recently took a position on the Teaching Council and State Examinations Commission—is arbitrarily and maliciously refusing to sign this standard administrative form to deliberately run down the statutory clock.

This refusal is not based on any objective disciplinary or academic failure, as my record is

unblemished. Instead, it is based on prejudicial profiling, the weaponization of my CPTSD symptoms, reliance on baseless familial rumors, and the highly inappropriate utilization of a 2023 psychiatric request that was improperly based on a misdiagnosis originating from a psychiatrist connected to my abusive older brother. This discrimination is undeniably systemic: previously glowing references from respected academics such as Cornelia Connolly and Kathy O'Sullivan have been suppressed or revoked under institutional pressure. Furthermore, despite holding a First Class Honours degree that far exceeds the minimum entry requirement, I was subjected to a discriminatory, catch-22 rejection from the Máistir Gairmiúil san Oideachas (MGO) programme, wherein the University blamed my lack of teaching experience—an experience deficit they themselves unlawfully created by refusing my Teaching Council reference.

The refusal to provide a standard reference at zero nominal cost is a blatant failure to provide reasonable accommodation under Section 4 of the Equal Status Acts. This systemic gaslighting has exacerbated my CPTSD, causing profound psychiatric injury and invoking the 'eggshell skull' doctrine of liability, while inflicting severe, irreparable reputational damage among my professional peers at Coláiste na Coiribe and Galway Community College.

Section 4: Less Favourable Treatment I have been treated significantly less favourably than able-bodied graduates. While neurotypical students with vastly inferior academic grades routinely receive standard character references and postgraduate programme acceptances as a basic ancillary service of the University, my professional progression has been actively sabotaged. My trauma-related anxiety has been weaponized by the faculty to label me as 'unfit', entirely ignoring my objective First Class Honours degree, my standing-ovation presentation in Computer Science, my rigorous analysis in the 'History of Irish Education', and my documented pedagogical excellence in Galway Community College.

Section 6: Request for Information Pursuant to the investigatory provisions of the Equal Status Acts, I formally request the following information:

1. Provide the specific, documented, objective academic or disciplinary rationale detailing why Professor Anthony Hall refuses to sign the Teaching Council character reference for a First Class Honours graduate.
2. Provide the scoring matrix and specific rationale for my rejection from the MGO programme, explaining the circular logic of demanding teaching experience while actively blocking my ability to obtain it.
3. Provide all internal communications and records regarding any institutional instructions or pressure applied to Cornelia Connolly or Kathy O'Sullivan to revoke, alter, or suppress their references.
4. Confirm whether the University's refusal of service is related to the inappropriate 2023 psychiatric request or external communications regarding my familial abuse history, rather than my objective academic record.

8. Remedial Framework: Statutory Offer of Amends (Defamation Act 2009)

Before initiating catastrophic High Court plenary proceedings for defamation and psychiatric personal injury, the most potent legal lever available to force a resolution is the "Offer of Amends" under Section 22 of the Defamation Act 2009.

By demanding that the University issue an Offer of Amends, the subject creates a legally binding ultimatum. If the University refuses to issue the apology, provide the reference, and

compensate the subject, their silence serves as incontrovertible proof of malice. This strips the institution of standard legal defenses in the High Court and maximizes financial liability under the eggshell skull doctrine.

The following correspondence must be sent via registered post to Professor Anthony Hall, the Head of the School of Education, and the Office of the University's Legal Counsel.

Subject: URGENT LEGAL NOTICE: Final Opportunity for Compromise via Statutory Offer of Amends (Defamation Act 2009), Notice of WRC Action, and Liability for Psychiatric Personal Injury.

To: Professor Anthony Hall, The Head of the School of Education, and the Legal Counsel, University of Galway,

This correspondence serves as a formal Pre-Action Notice and a final, good-faith attempt to achieve a mediated compromise regarding the sustained disability discrimination, administrative malpractice, and severe implicit defamation I have endured from the School of Education.

I am a disabled alumnus with an unblemished academic record. I hold a First Class Honours BA in Mathematics and Education (2021) and a First Class Honours Higher Diploma in Software Design (2023). My academic file includes a 70% grade in Final Year Block Teaching Practice, a highly commended Action Research Project on the Plickers educational technology system, a standing-ovation presentation on Computer Science, and glowing placement references from Galway Community College confirming my excellent attendance, deep subject knowledge, and gentle professional nature.

Concurrently, I manage Complex Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder (CPTSD) and an Anxiety Disorder. These conditions, stemming from severe familial abuse, the palliative care of my grandfather, and the care of my grandmother, were formally diagnosed by Dr. James McLoughlin in 2017 and supported by the University Access Centre.

Despite my objective excellence, the School of Education is engaged in the constructive dismissal of my entire academic career. By maliciously refusing to sign the Teaching Council's 'Fit and Proper Person' form as the five-year statutory window approaches its expiry in 2026, Professor Hall is attempting to render my degree professionally useless. Furthermore, the unexplained revocation of glowing references by Cornelia Connolly and Kathy O'Sullivan under institutional pressure, coupled with the circular, hypocritical rejection of my application to the MGO programme despite my far exceeding the minimum entry criteria, reveals an undeniable, coordinated institutional bias.

The refusal to sign a standard character reference when no objective disciplinary record exists constitutes a positive, implicit assertion that I am professionally unfit. This assertion is entirely false and is maliciously based on an inappropriate 2023 psychiatric request stemming from an abusive family member's misdiagnosis, alongside the discriminatory misinterpretation of my trauma symptoms.

This gaslighting has caused immense reputational damage, poisoning my relationships among my peers and past colleagues at Coláiste na Coiribe and Galway Community College. More severely, under the "eggshell skull" doctrine of Irish tort law, a defendant takes their victim as they find them. Your coordinated administrative harassment has caused a catastrophic exacerbation of my pre-existing CPTSD, resulting in profound psychiatric personal injury for which the University of Galway is now strictly and vicariously liable.

As a graduate who dedicated years to this institution, I have no desire to subject the University to a highly public Workplace Relations Commission (WRC) adjudication or protracted High Court plenary proceedings for defamation and personal injury. However, I will not allow my career to be destroyed by prejudice and whisper networks.

Pursuant to Section 22 of the Defamation Act 2009, I demand that the University of Galway

immediately issue a formal Offer of Amends. This offer must include:

1. **Immediate Remediation:** The immediate provision of the fully signed 'Fit and Proper Person' Form D for the Teaching Council by Professor Hall or the Head of School, allowing me to register and practice my profession.
2. **Correction and Retraction:** A formal, written apology acknowledging the implicit defamation caused by the delayed references and the biased MGO rejection, alongside a guarantee that my academic standing will no longer be obstructed.
3. **Compensation:** An offer to enter into confidential mediation to agree upon appropriate compensation for the severe psychiatric injury, loss of earnings, and distress caused by this protracted administrative discrimination.

If I do not receive a written confirmation of your intent to issue this Offer of Amends and supply the signed Teaching Council form within seven (7) days, I will proceed with full High Court litigation for defamation and negligence, alongside the formal lodging of the enclosed WRC ES.1 Notification for disability discrimination. The University's silence will be heavily relied upon in court as proof of ongoing malice and a refusal to mitigate damages.

Yours sincerely,

[Applicant Name] First Class Honours Alumnus, University Scholar (ID: 11476078)

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